test and when it was all done, I said, "Well?"

She didn't say anything, but walked into Walker's office. I assumed the worst.

Walker came out and said, "The glucose tolerance test is borderline."

"I'm an incipient diabetic, then?"

"No, not necessarily. This borderline appearance also shows up in obesity. Lose weight and take the test again."

Since I weighed two hundred pounds, I decided it was obesity. I tried to lose weight but didn't succeed; even the motivation of possible diabetes wasn't enough.

It might have been if the symptoms had grown worse and if other symptoms appeared—but those things didn't happen. Indeed, the boils became less frequent and finally vanished. I forgot about the matter and remained fat.

*9

Stories were simply flooding out of me now.

There were short-shorts like 'The Immortal Bard/' for instance, in which Shakespeare is brought back to life, takes a course in Shakespeare, and flunks, all in 900 words. This was directly inspired by Gotthard Guenther's remark to me, two years before, that an author need not know anything at all about the meaning of his story.

There were longer stories, like the 6,000-word "The Singing Bell," which dealt with a murder on the moon. I originally submitted it to Ellery Queen's Mystery Magazine, which rejected it. There was also the 9,000-word "It's Such a Beautiful Day," about a civilization in which transportation takes place through speed-of-light matter-transference— but one youngster prefers to walk.

"The Singing Bell" introduced my detective character, Wendell Urth, whose appearance I modeled on Norbert Wiener. He didn't like to travel (like myself, but worse) and remained always in his office.

Naturally, I intended to write another novel, but at the moment I had no ideas.

On November 17, 1953, however, I visited the BU Library, found that they